Refund Authorisation and Escalation Matrix

KARTWAY OPERATIONS POLICY MANUAL ## SECTION 4: REFUND AUTHORISATION AND FINANCIAL DISCRETION
Document ID: POL-OPS-402 Effective Date: 14 January 2026
Applies To: Customer Operations, Tier 1–3 Support Agents, Team Leads, Operations Managers, Finance Department

4.1 Purpose and Scope This policy defines the financial authorisation limits and approval workflows for all customer refunds, partial refunds, and goodwill credits processed through the Kartway platform. All support personnel are strictly bound by the thresholds and prohibitions detailed herein. Any deviation constitutes a violation of internal financial controls.

4.2 Refund Authorisation Matrix All refund requests must be routed according to the total monetary value of the transaction in Indian Rupees (INR). No employee may process a refund exceeding their designated tier limit.

Approval Tier	Role / System	Maximum Authorisation Limit (INR)	Mandatory Documentation Required
Tier 1	Automated System (Rule-based)	Up to ■2,000	System log, automated return receipt
Tier 1	Support Agent (Level 1 & 2)	Up to ■2,000	Customer statement, photo evidence (if applicable)
Tier 2	Team Lead	■2,001 to ■10,000	Agent escalation note, order audit trail
Tier 3	Operations Manager	■10,001 to ■50,000	Manager review ticket, inventory discrepancy report
Tier 4	Finance Department	Above ■50,000	Executive sign-off, legal/fraud compliance check

4.2.1 Automated System Constraints 1. The automated Kartway customer operations system is hard-capped at an absolute maximum auto-approval threshold of ■2,000. 2. An automated system may *never* auto-approve any refund exceeding ■2,000, regardless of the customer’s loyalty tier, historical lifetime value, account tenure, sentiment score, or automated risk-scoring output. 3. Any automated refund request exceeding ■2,000 must be hard-routed directly to the Tier 2 queue for manual review by a Team Lead.

4.3 Goodwill Credits Goodwill credits are non-cash promotional balances applied to a customer’s Kartway wallet to compensate for service failures, delivery delays, or minor platform friction.

1. Lower Cap: Goodwill credits are subject to a separate, restricted cap of ■500 per customer account per calendar month. Agents may issue goodwill credits up to ■500 without Tier 2 escalation.
2. Exceeding the Cap: Goodwill credit requests between ■501 and ■2,500 require explicit written approval from a Team Lead. Goodwill credits exceeding ■2,500 require Operations Manager sign-off.
3. Stacking Prohibition: Goodwill credits may not be stacked with a full monetary refund on the same order.
- *Example:* If a customer receives a 100% monetary refund for a damaged item on Order #KW-98421, an agent is strictly prohibited from issuing a goodwill credit for that same order. Goodwill credits may only be issued as standalone compensation when a monetary refund has *not* been claimed for the specific grievance.

4.4 Enforcement and Audit 1. All refund transactions are subject to weekly random sampling by the Kartway Internal Audit Team. 2. Agents found splitting orders or artificially lowering refund amounts to bypass tier thresholds will face disciplinary action up to and including immediate termination of employment.